Ans. (d) : The correct match of List I and List II is :

Vikram era	58B.C.
Saka era	78A.D
Gupta era	320B.C
Kali era	3102 B.C

8. Who among the following anticipated Newton by declaring that all things gravitate to the earth?
(a) Aryabhata (b) Varahamihira
(c) Buddhagupta (d) Brahmagupta

Ans. (d) : The first modern equivalent of numeral zero comes from a Hindu astronomer and mathematician Brahmagupta in 628. His symbol to depict the numeral was a dot underneath a number. He anticipated that all things gravitate it the earth. Brahmagupta in AD 628, wrote that "bodies fall towards the earth as it is in the nature of the earth to attract bodies, just as it is in the nature of water to flow".

9. According to the Mimamsa system of philosophy, liberation is possible by means of:
(a) Jnana (b) Bhakti
(c) Yoga (d) Karma

Ans. (d) : This philosophy encompasses the Nyaya-vaisheshika systems and emphasises the concept of valid knowledge. According to Purva Mimamsa, Vedas are eternal and possess all knowledge. It says that the essence of the Vedas is dharma. By the execution of dharma one earns merit which leads one to heaven after death. Mimamsa philosophy was founded by Jaimini. According to Karma Mimamsa system of philosophy, liberation is possible by means of action (karma).

10. In Sanskrit plays written during the Gupta Period women and sudras speak:
(a) Sanskrit (b) Prakrit
(c) Pali (d) Sauraseni

Ans. (b) : In the Gupta period, the languages used by the people of low society level and women was prakrit. The word, derived from its Indian root "Parikrit", itself has a flexible definition, being defined sometime as, "original, natural, artless, normal, ordinary, usual", or "vernacular", in contrast to the literary and religious orthodoxy of Sanskrit. Sanskrit language reaches its peak during Gupta period .Many play written during Gupta period were in Sanskrit language.
Famous Sanskrit writer in time of Gupta reign were Kalidasa,Vishakhadutta and Sudrak.

11. The Nagara, the Dravida and the Vesara are:
(a) The three main racial groups of the Indian subcontinent
(b) The three main linguistic divisions into which the languages of India can be classified
(c) The three main styles of Indian temple architecture
(d) The three main musical gharan as prevalent in India

Ans. (c) : Ancient Indian temples are classified in three broad types. This classification is based on different architectural styles, employed in the construction of the temples. Three main style of temple architecture are the Nagara or the Northern style, the Dravida or the Southern style and the Vesara or Mixed style.
Nagara style temple is well developed in the region of north India. The distinctive feature of these type of temple is long shikhara as compared to mandapa. Originally in Nagara style, there were no pillars.
Dravida style advanced in the South, throughout the Chola Empire, between 9th-12th Century AD. In Dravida style temple is situated within an ambulatory hall. There is multiple storeys called Vimana, built above the Garbhagriha. Pillars and pilasters are massively used in this architectural style.
Many temples in Central India and Deccan have used the Vesara style with regional modifications. It is a fusion style of both Nagara and Dravida styles of temple architecture .Temples built but later Chalukyas of Kalyani and Hoysalas are considered as the examples of Vesara style.

MEDIEVAL HISTORY

12. Bronze icons of Nataraja cast during the Chola period invariably show the deity with:
(a) Eight hands (b) Six hands
(c) Four hands (d) Two hands

Ans. (c) : Bronze icons of Nataraja cast during chola period invariably show the deity with four hands.
The making of bronze sculptures mainly made from wax casting reached a high stage of development in South India during the Medieval Period. The dancing figure of Shiva as Natraja evolved and fully developed during the Chola Period and since then many variation of this complex bronze image have been modeled.

13. Which one of the following monuments has a dome which is said to be one of the largest in the world?
(a) Tomb of Sher Shah, Sasaram
(b) Jama Masjid, Delhi
(c) Tomb of Ghiyas-ud-din Tughlaq, Delhi
(d) Gol Gumbaz, Bijapur

Ans. (d) : Gol Gumbaz is the most famous monument in Vijayapura (Bijapur). It is the tomb of Mohammed Adil Shah (ruled 1627-1657). It is one of the largest dome ever built in the world. A particular attraction in this monument is the central chamber, where every sound is echoed several times.

14. Who among the following were famous jurists of medieval India?
I. Vijnanesvara II. Hemadri
III. Rajasekhara IV. Jimutavahana
Choose the correct answer from the codes given below:
Codes:
(a) I, II and III (b) II, III and IV
(c) I, II and IV (d) I and IV

Ans. (c) : Rajashekhar was the Sanskrit poet in the court of Mahendrapala I. He wrote the Kavyamimasa.
Vijnanesvara, Hemadri and Jimutavahana were prominent jurist in Medieval India.

15. Ashtapradhan was a Council of Ministers:
(a) In the Gupta Administration
(b) In the Chola Administration
(c) In the Vijayanagar Administration
(d) In the Maratha Administration

Ans. (d) : The eight prominent officials of Maratha were known as Astha Pradhan.
They were as follows:

Peshwa	–	(Prime Minister)
Amatya or Mazumdar	–	Finance Minister
Waqia-Navis	–	(Home Minister)
Samant or Dabir	–	(Dealing with the outside)
Sachiv	–	(The official correspondence)
Pandit Rao	–	(The official religious officer)
Sar-i-naubat	–	(army affairs)
Nyayadhish	–	(Judiciary)

16. Consider the, map given below:



The route indicated in the map was followed, during the course of his military exploits, by
(a) Chandragupta II (b) Harshavardhana
(c) Rajendra Chola (d) Malik Kafur

Ans. (d) : The route indicated in the map was followed, during the course of his military exploits by Malik Kafur.
As a commander of Alauddin's force, Malik Kafur defeated the Mongol invaders in 1306 and subsequently, be led a series of expeditions in the southern part of India, against the Yadavas, the Kakatiyas, the Hoysalas and the Pandays.

17. The Mughal School of Painting formed the spinal column of the various schools of Indian miniature art. Which one of the following painting styles was not affected by Mughal painting?
(a) Pahari (b) Rajasthani
(c) Kangra (d) Kalighata

Ans. (d) : Kalighata painting was not affected by Mughal school of painting as it originated in the 19th century in West Bengal, India in the vicinity of Kalighat Kali Temple, calcutta.
It mainly depicted Hindu gods and other Mythological characters, the Kalighat painting developed to reflect a variety of subjects, including many depictions of everyday life. Mughal School of painting originated in the reign of Akbar in 1560 C.E. who was keenly interested in the art of painting and architecture. The mughal style evolved as a result of a happy synthesis of the indigenous Indian style of painting and safavid school of Persian Painting.
There was a prominent affect of Mughal paintings on Pahari, Rajasthan, Kangra painting styles but it does not affected Kalighata style of paintings.

MODERN HISTORY

18. The 'Modi script' was employed in the documents of the:
(a) Wodeyars (b) Zamorins
(c) Hoysalas (d) Marathas

Ans. (d) : Modi script emerged in the 1400 as a shorthand variant of the Devanagri used by scribes. It was used for writing Marathi. This script was once an essential part of Marathi literary culture but currently it is on verge of extinction and are used on very limited scale.

19. In the interim government formed in 1946, the Vice-President of the Executive Council was:
(a) Jawaharlal Nehru
(b) Dr. S. Radhakrishnan
(c) C. Rajagopalachari
(d) Dr. Rajendra Prasad

Ans. (a) : In the interim government formed in 1946, the vice President of the executive council was Jawaharlal Nehru.
C. Rajgopalchari was incharge of education department. Dr. Rajendra Prasad was incharge of food and agriculture department. Dr. S. Radhakrishnan became